Establishment (PXE) at Chandipur in Balasore district of Orissa. A funding of Rs 30 crores had been given to construct the range, cal ed the Interim Test Range (ITR). Dr HS Rama Rao and his team did an excel ent job of working out innovative and cost-effective specifications for electro-optical tracking instruments, a tracking telescope system and an instrumentation tracking radar. Lt Gen RS Deswal and Maj Gen KN Singh took charge of creating the launch pad and range infrastructure. There was a beautiful bird sanctuary in Chandipur. I asked the engineers to design the test range without disturbing it.

Creating the RCI was perhaps the most satisfying experience of my life. Developing this centre of excel ence of missile technology was akin to the joy of a potter shaping artifacts of lasting beauty from the mundane clay.

Defence Minister R Venkataraman visited DRDL in September 1983 to appraise himself of the activities of IGMDP. He advised us to list al the resources we needed to achieve our goals, overlooking nothing, and then include in the list our own positive imagination and faith. “What you imagine, is what wil transpire. What you believe is what you wil achieve,” he said. Both Dr Arunachalam and I saw in